

2024 年全国大学生英语竞赛决赛（B 类）

Part I Listening Comprehension

Section A

1.D 【解析】题目问摩托车比赛将在哪里结束。对话中女士说不知道摩托车比赛在哪里结束，什么时候开始。男士回答说今年的摩托车比赛将在市中心结束。预计周六下午将有数百人聚集在市政厅前的广场上观看比赛的结束。由此可知，D 项“在市政厅前”，符合题意。

2.A 【解析】题目问约翰的旅游节目有什么特别之处。对话中，女士问约翰能谈谈他制作的旅游节目吗。男士约翰回答说很多旅游节目都是关于在海滩上放松的假期，但他只拍过关于长途旅行的纪录片。由此可知，A 项“它们几乎只适用于长途旅行”，符合题意。

3.B 【解析】题目问男士认为谁会赢。对话中,男士说在他看来,今年的决赛将在安迪和蒂姆之间进行,但他们将在半决赛中相遇。他认为那场比赛的结果将由事实决定,事实是蒂姆的伤势还没有完全恢复。由此可知,男士认为安迪会赢得比赛。

4.C 【解析】题目问为什么女士考试没考好。对话中女士说因为这是最后一次考试,她把复习留到最后一刻,不能把需要复习的都复习了。当她阅读问题时,她意识到自己不能像她希望的那样回答所有的问题。由此可知,C项“她没有做好充分的准备”,符合题意。

5.D 【解析】题目问这位女士想要表达什么意思。对话中女士说售货员根本没注意她,只是看着男士。售货员认为女士负担不起,故意不理她。由此可知,D项“售货员故意不理睬她”,符合题意。

Section B

Conversation One

6.A 【解析】题目问迈克尔什么时候最有可能接受他得到的角色。对话中提到,迈克尔认为更重要的是这个角色的新鲜感。他认为这个角色太过时了——那种我们在银幕上一遍遍看到的角色,他会拒绝它。另一方面,如果这个角色新鲜且具有挑战性,他就会认真考虑。因此选A。

7.B 【解析】题目问迈克尔出道时,好莱坞是如何看待英国男演员的。对话中提到,就像今天一样(迈克尔出道时),好莱坞设定了标准,来自英国的男演员主要被考虑出演更敏感的角色,而不是全动作角色。由此可知,他们不适合全动作角色,故选B。

8.D 【解析】题目问迈克尔认为一部电影成功的基础是什么。对话中提到,迈克尔认为,如果全体演员和导演合作制作了一些特别的东西,一些与众不同的东西,那么票房成功就会成为次要的。因此迈克尔认为一部电影成功的基础是拍摄团队的配合,故选D。

9.B 【解析】题目问迈克尔认为哪些角色是他最擅长的。对话中提到,迈克尔想过很多次,他得出的结论是,当他和一个有默契的演员演对手戏的时候,他的最佳表演时刻就来了。因此选B。

10.C 【解析】题目问关于未来,迈克尔说了什么。对话中提到,迈克尔想过这个问题,但他一直觉得他的位置是在镜头前,而且一直是这样,直到他不能再做演员为止。由此可知,关于未来,迈克尔计划尽可能长时间地继续演戏,故选C。

Conversation Two

11.confusing 【解析】对话中提到“while I think you have some really original ideas, the structure I find a bit confusing”即女士认为男士的论文有一些很有创意的想法,但女士觉得结构有点混乱。因此本空填 confusing。

12.electronic 【解析】对话中提到“It would be a lot easier for me if you could email me an electronic copy, so that I can write some comments on it and send it back to you by the end of the day. That way you'll have time to take on board any feedback or comments before Friday.”即女士对男士说,如果男士能给女士发一份电子版的话,她就方便多了,这样她就可以在上面写一些评论,然后在今天结束前发给男士。这样男士就有时间在周五之前接受任何反馈或评论。因此本空填 electronic。

13.trade 【解析】对话中提到“you wrote about the development of Glasgow in the 19th century, from a small town to a major trade centre in Europe.”即男士写了格拉斯哥在19世纪的发展,从一个小镇发展成为欧洲主要的贸易中心。因此本空填 trade。

14.shipbuilding 【解析】对话中提到“the main reason seems to be the fact that shipbuilding techniques improved dramatically”,即格拉斯哥从一个小镇发展成为欧洲主要的贸易中心的主要原因是造船技术的巨大进步。因此本空填 shipbuilding。

15.smog 【解析】对话中提到“You'll have seen the old films where the air was full of smog, and this was the result of factory pollution. It wasn't until the Clear Air Act was introduced in 1956 that Glasgow's air became cleaner, along with the rest of the country.”你会看到老电影里空气中充满了烟雾,这是工厂污染的结果。直到1956年《清洁空气法》出台,格拉斯哥的空气才和全国其他地区一样变得更加清洁。因此本空填 smog。

Section C

16.A 【解析】题目问科学家们说光对昆虫有什么帮助。新闻中提到,伦敦帝国理工学院的生物学家报告说,昆虫被光线吸引是因为光线有助于它们在飞行时确定方向。因此光可以帮助昆虫在飞行时确定方向,故选A。

17.B 【解析】题目问微生物学家说冲厕所后什么被污染了。新闻中提到,微生物学家查尔斯·戈巴博士说,冲水会把盖子下面的细菌挤出来,污染附近的区域。因此冲厕所后附近的区域被污染了,故选B。

18.D 【解析】题目问红火蚁在世界各地蔓延多久了。新闻中提到,这种小蚂蚁原产于南美洲,但在过去的一个世纪里已经遍布全球。因此选D。

19.C 【解析】题目问哪些类型的知识有助于孩子们的生存。新闻中提到，孩子们对丛林中食物的了解以及对地形的经验可能给了他们更好的生存机会。因此选 C。

20.B 【解析】题目问我们可以从新闻中了解到什么。新闻中提到，一名公司发言人表示，这项新举措是为了确保遵守航班的安全标准。因此选 B。

Section D

21. On August Bank Holiday weekend.

【解析】题目问诺丁山狂欢节什么时候举行。听力材料中提到“*It is a yearly event that takes place on August Bank Holiday weekend*”，即诺丁山狂欢节是一年一度的活动，在 8 月的银行假日周末举行，因此本题答案为 On August Bank Holiday weekend。

22. Their former masters’.

【解析】题目问特立尼达人民在加勒比海嘉年华会上模仿谁的风格。听力材料中提到“*Having been forbidden from holding any festival of their own before, the people of Trinidad rebelled by dressing up in European style costumes and whitening their faces with flour or wearing white masks to imitate the style of their former masters, a tradition which is reflected in the costumes of today.*”即由于以前被禁止举行任何自己的节日，特立尼达人民进行了反叛，他们穿着欧洲风格的服装，用面粉把脸漂白，或戴上白色的面具，模仿他们以前主人的风格，这一传统反映在今天的服装中。因此本题答案为 Their former masters’。

23. A street party.

【解析】题目问早期的狂欢节是从什么演变而来的。听力材料中提到“*A street party organized for neighbourhood children turned into a carnival procession when the steel band decided to take a walk while playing their music and were joined by an enthusiastic crowd.*”即一场为邻居孩子们组织的街头派对变成了一场狂欢节游行，当时钢铁乐队决定一边演奏他们的音乐一边散步，热情的人群也加入了进来。因此本题答案为 A street party。

24. A year./A whole year.

【解析】题目问乐队为音乐节做准备要花多长时间。听力材料中提到“*After a whole year of preparation, the carnival bands take to the streets on Sunday and Bank Holiday Monday from 9 a. m. to 7 p. m.*”，经过一年的准备，狂欢乐队在周日和周一的银行假日从上午 9 点到晚上 7 点走上街头。因此本题答案为 A year./A whole year。

25. Public transport.

【解析】题目问说话者建议人们在节日期间使用什么交通工具。听力材料中提到“*Public transport is your best option*”即公共交通是你最好的选择，因此本题答案为 Public transport。

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar

26.B 【解析】句意：双方必须同意遵守协议的条款。A 项意为“课文，文字”，B 项意为“条件，条款；学期”，C 项意为“方法，办法”，D 项意为“手段，方法”。该句中 parties 意为“党派”，abide by 意为“遵守”，agreement 意为“协议，协定”，均属于法律英语，B 项的 terms 在法律英语中是“条款”的意思，符合题意。

27.A 【解析】句意：装有玻璃器皿的包裹上标明“易碎品”。A 项意为“易碎的，易损的”，主要用于标识易碎或脆弱的物品，常出现在包装上；B 项意为“（人）脆弱的，虚弱的；（性格、道德方面）脆弱的，意志薄弱的”，C 项意为“虚弱的，纤弱的；灵巧的；（仪器）灵敏的”，D 项意为“（身体或精神）脆弱的，易受伤的；（事物、人或地方）易受攻击的”。该句中 glassware 指“玻璃制品”，由于玻璃易碎，所以装有玻璃制品的包裹会标注“易碎品”，故选 A。

28.B 【解析】句意：国防部最近的一份文件描绘了一幅未来严峻现实的画面。报告警告说，如果目前的消费模式继续下去，到 2045 年，世界三分之二的人口将最终生活在“缺水”情况下。ruthless 意为“无情的，冷酷的”，grim 意为“严酷的：令人沮丧的”，severe 意为“严重的：严厉的”，cruel 意为“残忍的；严酷的”，都可以与 reality 搭配，表示“残酷严峻的现实”；break out 意为“爆发”，end up 意为“结束；最终”，come round 意为“苏醒；改变主意”；set down 意为“放下”。结合句意可知，第二空填入 end up 符合语境，故选 B。

29.D 【解析】句意：希腊基克拉迪群岛的独特之处在于那些古色古香的白色房屋。A 项意为“搁置；留出”；B 项意为“到来”，C 项意为“出发；引起”，D 项意为“使分离；使显得突出”。分析句子结构可知，该句为强调句，强调句子的主语，空格处为句子的谓语部分，主语意为“古色古香的白色房屋”，宾语意为“希腊基克拉迪群岛”，结合句意可知 set apart 符合语境，故选 D。

30.C 【解析】句意：随着人类从出生到死亡经历各个人生阶段，他们通过多种途径获取关于周围世界的知识，其中就包括感官感知。第一个空格前后均为名词（结构），即空格处作定语，join 意

为“加入”，bridge 意为“在……上架桥；弥合（分歧），消除（隔阂）”；span 意为“持续，贯穿；涵盖”，link 意为“连接”，结合句意可知，第一个空格后表达的是“从出生到死亡的时期”，为一个跨度，span 符合题意；第二个空格中，结合选项可知，among other things 为固定短语，意为“此外，除了其他方面”，通常用作插入语，表示举例，该句表达的是人类获取知识有很多途径，其中就有“感知感官”，故选 C。

31.B 【解析】句意：学校的科学实验室被烧毁后，许多学生受到了审讯。然而，警方未能收集到足够的证据来提出指控。A 项意为“起诉，控告，检举”，B 项意为“审问，讯问，质问”，C 项意为“撤回，撤销”，D 项意为“不公正地对待；处罚，惩罚”。结合句意可知，interrogated 符合语境，即学生被审讯了，故选 B。

32.D 【解析】句意：英语中的辅音 [f] 可以被正确描述为有以下语音特征：清辅音，唇齿音，摩擦音。结合语音学知识可知，辅音的分类方式有三种，分别为发音方式，发音部位和带声性。根据发音方式，英语的辅音可以分为爆破音、摩擦音、塞擦音、流音、鼻音和滑音。根据发音部位，可以分为双唇音、唇齿音、齿音、齿龈音、腭音、软腭音和喉音。根据气流产生声音时声带震动的情况，可分为清辅音和浊辅音。[f] 的发音特征是摩擦音，唇齿音和清辅音，故选 D。

33.C 【解析】句意：你可能不喜欢那出戏，但是当你得到一张剧院的免费票时，你不应该吹毛求疵。A 项意为“因噎废食；得不偿失”，B 项意为“既能享乐也能吃苦”，C 项意为“吹毛求疵；挑剔别人的礼物”，D 项意为“大海捞针”，结合句意可知，C 项符合题意。

34.A 【解析】句意：维鲁拉米恩博物馆是该国最受欢迎的罗马生活博物馆之一。自 1991 年重新布展以来，年度参观人数已上升至 9 万人。第一个空格处的逻辑主语是维鲁拉米恩博物馆 (Verulamium)，指物，故填入 itself；第二个空格，选项中 rise 是不及物动词，raise 是及物动词，及物动词后面需要接宾语，两者都表示“增加；提高”之意，由于空格后是介词 to，所以应选择不及物动词，故选 A。

35.C 【解析】句意：艾尔斯伯里是一个繁华的集市城镇，其现代化的购物设施包括最近开业的弗里尔广场购物中心。第一个空格处，foreign 意为“外国的”，deserted 意为“空旷的；废弃的”，bustling 意为“繁华的；热闹的”，permanent 意为“永恒的；永久的”。第二个空格，frequently 意为“频繁地”，likely 意为“可能的”，recently 意为“最近”，rarely 意为“罕见地”。结合句意可知，故选 C。

36.D 【解析】句意：我选择文学作为我的专业，因为我真的不适合理科。事实上，我好几次数学和物理不及格。A 项意为“在我看来”，B 项意为“尽管如此”，C 项意为“然而，尽管如此”，D 项意为“事实上”。D 项表示强调，加强语气，符合语境。

37.C 【解析】句意：鉴于远程办公正在成为常态，各公司正加大对高科技工具的投资。Owning to 和 Due to 都表示“由于”，后接名词；On condition that 表示条件，后接从句；Given the fact that 用于引出一个已知的事实，常用于强调某个结果的理由或依据，后接从句。结合句意可知，两个分句是因果关系，故选 C。

38.A 【解析】句意：由于没有什么可讨论的了，会议提前半小时结束了。分析句子结构可知，该句为独立主格结构，逗号前后的两部分之间没有连词，而后面是完整的句子，因此逗号前面不是句子，谓语部分用非谓语结构，there to be 表示还没有发生，不符合句意，there being 表示原因，符合句意，故选 A。

39.B 【解析】句意：米娅：你觉得动物园很好玩，不是吗？文森特：是呀，比上次旅行好多了。那个博物馆太无聊了。昆虫屋太棒了——绝对是我最喜欢的部分。我就是喜欢这样的东西。米娅：真的吗？我觉得很可怕——所有那些虫子和令人毛骨悚然的小爬虫——我觉得有点儿可怕。我喜欢毛茸茸的东西——猴子或猫鼬。它们太可爱了。A 项意为“嗯，这取决于你”，B 项意为“真的吗？我觉得很可怕”，C 项意为“是的，我觉得你是对的”，D 项意为“在这一点上我们的看法是一致的”，空格后的 creepy 和 scary 都表达出米娅对昆虫屋的态度是消极的，故选 B。

40.A 【解析】句意：海伦：你记得我告诉过你我想搬到国外吗？马修：记得，但我觉得你不是认真的。海伦：可能当时我不是真的那样想，但现在是的。我已经申请了三份工作。马修：嗯，祝你好运，如果你搬到国外了，别忘记邀请我。海伦：别担心，我不会忘记的。A 项意为“别担心；我不会的”，B 项意为“我答应我会”，C 项意为“我盼望回复”，D 项意为“我不确定”。因此选 A。

Part III Cloze

Section A

【原文翻译】

提提卡卡湖位于秘鲁和玻利维亚之间，占地面积约 58,000 平方公里，海拔 3,800 米。由于它的最大深度接近 300 米，大型船只可以在湖上航行，使其成为世界上最高的可通航水域。维持其巨大体积所需的水源来自安第斯山脉一些主要山峰附近融化的降雨和雪水。总共有 25 条河流流入提提卡

卡湖，由于它们的源头位于高山之上，流入湖中的水相当冷。

尽管地理位置如此偏远，提提卡卡湖和它的 41 个岛屿仍是一个受欢迎的度假胜地。壮观的景色，包括当太阳出来照射时由灰色变成蓝色的湖泊本身，藏有印加宝藏的黄金博物馆，美味的食物和热情好客的当地人，都使它成为勇敢的旅行者必去的地方。

41.covers 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：提提卡卡湖位于秘鲁和玻利维亚之间，占地面积约 58,000 平方公里，海拔 3,800 米。分析句子结构可知，空格前是由 which 引导的定语从句，Lake Titicaca 为该句的主语，空格后为名词 area，故空格处应填入动词，与 and 后面的 lies 作并列谓语。结合备用选项可得，cover an area of...，意为“占地面积……”，符合语境，故此处应填入 covers。

42.depth 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：由于它的最大深度接近 300 米，大型船只可以在湖上航行，使其成为世界上最高的可通航水域。空格位于形容词 maximum 和介词 of 之间，故空格处应填入名词。由于 of 后面内容是“300 米”，结合备用选项可得，depth 符合语境，故此处应填入 depth。

43.sources 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：总共有 25 条河流流入提提卡卡湖，由于它们的源头位于高山之上，流入湖中的水相当冷。空格处为从句的主语，空格后是 be 动词，故空格处应填入名词，且用复数形式。此处表示“因为水源头在高山之上，所以流入湖的水很冷”，结合备用选项可得，source 意为“来源；河流源头，发源地”，符合语境，故此处应填入 sources。

44.remote 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：尽管地理位置如此偏远，提提卡卡湖和它的 41 个岛屿仍是一个受欢迎的度假胜地。空格位于 being so 之后，故空格处应填入形容词，结合备用选项可得，remote 意为“偏僻的，边远的”，此处表示“尽管地理位置如此偏远但仍然热门”，符合语境，故此处应填入 remote。

45.containing 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：壮观的景色，包括当太阳出来照射时由灰色变成蓝色的湖泊本身，藏有印加宝藏的黄金博物馆，美味的食物和热情好客的当地人，都使它成为勇敢的旅行者必去的地方。该句中 including 为介词，后接并列成分有 lake、museum、food 和 locals，这些构成景色，空格位于名词 museum 之后，故空格处应填入非谓语动词，和 Inca treasures 构成后置定语，修饰 museum，结合备用选项可得，contain 意为“包含”，符合语境，故此处应填入 containing。

Section B

【原文翻译】

虽然邱园经常被许多到伦敦的海外游客所忽视，但有些游客认为邱园是一个值得多次游览的地方。这座联合国教科文组织世界遗产已有 250 多年的历史，是全球最大的单一地点活体植物收藏地。由于有 700 多万标本需要照顾和研究，邱园的大部分员工都是园艺工作人员和科学家。

对于那些没有足够的冒险精神独自探索花园的游客，园内有其他工作人员提供每天两次的导游服务。步行游览的亮点通常包括参观炎热而潮湿的睡莲屋以及在高出地面 18 米高的树冠走廊上欣赏壮观的景色。

如果长距离步行不可能，邱园提供了一个很好的替代方式——环保型公路列车，它是由燃气驱动的，因此对环境的污染最小。这段旅程还配有司机的解说，以确保乘客充分了解沿途植物生命的令人难以置信的多样性。

46.visitors 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：虽然邱园经常被许多到伦敦的海外游客所忽视，但有些游客认为邱园是一个值得多次游览的地方。空格位于 some 之后，故空格处应填入名词，该句为主从复合句，从句为 although 引导的让步状语从句，结合句意并根据提示字母可知。空格处指一些“游客”，与从句中的许多“游客”形成对比，故此处应填入 visitors。

47.living 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：这座联合国教科文组织世界遗产已有 250 多年的历史，是全球最大的单一地点活体植物收藏地。空格位于介词 of 和名词 plants 之间，故空格处应填入形容词。根据提示字母可知，live 的形容词形式有 lively、living 和 live，lively 意为“活泼的，生气勃勃的”，没有“活着的”意思，living 意为当前“活着的”，表达一种生命持续的状态，live 意为“有生命的；活着的”，多指动物，空格后是 plants，故此处应填入 living。

48.twice 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：对于那些没有足够的冒险精神独自探索花园的游客，园内有其他工作人员提供每天两次的导游服务。分析句子结构可知，空格所在句为 there be 句型，该句型中含有 who 引导的定语从句，空格处和后面的 a day 构成时间状语，根据提示词 two 可知，该处指提供导游服务的频率，即每天两次，用法为“序数词 + a day”，故此处应填入 twice。

49.above 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是：步行游览的亮点通常包括参观炎热而潮湿的睡莲屋以及在高出地面 18 米高的树冠走廊上欣赏壮观的景色。由该句中的 treetop walkway 可知，句中所说的 spectacular views 是在树冠走廊看到的效果，所以这个视角是在地面以上的树冠位置。因此空

格处表示地面以上 18 米正好是树冠的位置, 故此处应填入 above。

50.journey 【解析】空格处所在句子的意思是: 这段旅程还配有司机的解说, 以确保乘客充分了解沿途植物生命的令人难以置信的多样性。空格位于定冠词 the 和 be 动词之间, 所以空格处应填入名词, 结合句意并根据提示字母可知, 空格处内容是指“乘坐公路列车游邱园”这趟旅程, 故此处应填入 journey。

Part IV Reading Comprehension

【原文翻译】

在电脑上进行搜索是我们不假思索就会做的事情。然而, 根据一项研究, 仅进行两次搜索所需的能量就相当于烧开一杯茶所需的能量。因此, 这两次搜索可以将大约 14g 的二氧化碳释放到大气中。不幸的是, 这只是故事的一半, 因为那些运行搜索引擎的公司也会污染大气。

在最近的一份报告中, 据估计全球 IT 行业产生的二氧化碳排放量大约占全球总量的 2%。这相当于航空业向大气中排放的量。互联网搜索提供商之所以耗费如此多的电力, 是因为数据中心的能源消耗极高, 因为每个数据中心都包含存储数十亿网页的数据库, 所有这些网页都需要电力才能运行。

尽管领先的互联网搜索提供商声称他们正试图使计算尽可能环保, 但搜索引擎由于其运作方式还是会产生大量的二氧化碳。当输入要搜索的内容时, 请求指令不仅仅依赖于一个服务器。它会向多个相互竞争提供所需数据的服务器发送指令。这样的服务器可能相距数千英里。例如, 谷歌在美国、欧洲和日本都有服务器。

任何互联网搜索引擎的主要目标都是尽可能快地向用户提供数据。因此, 它们采用的系统会最大限度地减少延迟来吸引坐在电脑前的人。然而, 缺点是, 随着满足搜索中的个人需求, 能源消耗量增加了。

就个人用户而言, 还进行了几项其他研究, 以确定它们释放到大气中的二氧化碳量。确切数字根据具体情况而有所不同。例如, 查看一个简单的网页会产生约 0.02g 的二氧化碳, 而查看一个具有复杂图像或视频的网站会产生 10 倍于此的二氧化碳。尽管这些研究得出了不同的结论, 但人们普遍认为, 平均而言, 运行一台个人电脑每小时会产生 40g 到 80g 的二氧化碳。

这些数据导致了人们将西方人的娱乐用电与其他国家的能源贫困之间进行了比较。例如, 在《第二人生》这款虚拟现实游戏中, 维持一个角色所需的电量是每年 1752 千瓦时。这本身似乎并不过分。然而, 与较贫穷地区的个人用电量相比, 显然是过分的, 因为它仅比同期巴西人均用电量略低。

由于计算机的能源消耗显然是由于对速度的需求的增长的, 所以唯一可以降低能源消耗的方法是通过检查互联网的时间和方式。如果使用互联网取代了更多能源消耗的活动, 比如驾驶, 这是一件好事。如果它取代的是那些需要较少或没有能源消耗的活动, 那这是有害的。同样地, 使用推特发送无关紧要的信息与朋友保持联系不仅仅是有趣的, 而且也不环保。

51.E 【解析】E 项的意思是“这相当于航空业向大气中排放的量。”空格前一句提到, 全球 IT 行业产生的二氧化碳排放量大约占全球总量的 2%。空格后的句子为解释网络搜索引擎供应商耗费大量电力的原因, 因此空格处表示“全球 IT 行业能源消耗较大”。E 项与上下文衔接紧密, 故选 E。

52.B 【解析】B 项的意思是“当输入要搜索的内容时, 请求指令不仅仅依赖于一个服务器。”空格前提到, 搜索引擎由于其运作方式还是会产生大量的二氧化碳。因此空格处应是介绍搜索引擎的运作方式, 空格后第二句中提到了 servers, 结合备用选项可得, B 项符合题意, 与上下文衔接紧密, 故选 B。

53.D 【解析】D 项的意思是“任何互联网搜索引擎的主要目标都是尽可能快地向用户提供数据。”由空格后的 Therefore 可知, 后面表示结果, 因此空格处内容表示原因。空格后的 they 指的是像谷歌一样的网络提供商, 结合备用选项可得, D 项符合题意, 即“因为网络提供商想尽快提供数据, 所以会减少延迟吸引顾客”, 故选 D。

54.A 【解析】A 项的意思是“确切数字根据具体情况而有所不同。”空格前的句子提到, 人们还进行了几项其他研究, 以确定个人用户的二氧化碳排放量。空格后的句子提到二氧化碳的排放量但没有给出具体而统一的数据, 因此空格内容表示“个人用户在不同情况下产生的二氧化碳的量是不同的”, A 项符合题意, 故选 A。

55.G 【解析】G 项的意思是“如果使用互联网取代了更多能源消耗的活动, 比如驾驶, 这是一件好事。”空格前一句提到, 唯一可以降低能源消耗的方法是通过检查互联网的时间和方式。空格后提到, 如果它取代的是那些需要较少或没有能源消耗的活动, 那这是有害的。结合备用选项可得, G 项与上下文衔接紧密, 故选 G。

Section B

【原文翻译】

当你接近登机口时, 你的心跳开始加快, 你开始出汗。你开始恐慌, 因为你对飞行的恐惧即将压倒你。尽管你有逃离的冲动, 但你会继续有序地前进。那么, 你是如何抵制住离开机场的诱惑呢?

最简单的答案就是从一开始就不去那里。你通过虚拟环境中代表你的动画化身，经历了整个体验。在现实中，你从来没有在机场：你只在电脑里的机场上。然而，根据最近的一项研究，观看你的数字形象在模拟机场登机以及如何处理机场焦虑的经历足以帮助你应对现实世界中的这种情况。

在虚拟世界中，虚拟角色的外表通常与操控它们的人并不相似。一个典型的例子就是《魔兽世界》中流行的虚拟设置，其中的虚拟角色采用矮人和精灵的形式以及其他神话人物。然而，当用户面部的数码照片被整合到虚拟形象中时，它们看起来就像用户本人一样可怕。这样的化身被称为“替身”，它们对我们有强大的影响。事实上，据说只要花三分钟看自己的替身，就能影响我们的学习能力、行为甚至观点。考虑到这些说法，我们的身份似乎最终会成为真实自我和虚拟表象的结合，彼此不可分割。

虚拟角色对我们的影响被称为“替身效应”。尽管它的潜力现在已被广泛认识，但在数字时代之前，老师们就已经知道并应用了这种效果，他们使用木偶来说明他们想要传达的观点。然而，木偶成为有效的教学工具的原因是未知的，直到使用脑部扫描发现人们谈论自己的虚拟形象和现实生活经历时大脑一部分变得活跃起来。事实证明，它们非常相似，这意味着我们在虚拟世界中的经历与在现实世界中的遭遇几乎是一样的。而且，与其他类型的信息相比，我们往往更能有效地记住个人信息，所以使用虚拟角色，尤其是替身，可以成为一种有效的学习工具。

除了能够在教育中发挥作用外，替身还可以用来激励我们采取更健康的生活方式。研究表明，我们的行为可以通过使用自己的数字图像来改变。在最近的一项实验中，一组学生目睹了他们的虚拟形象在屏幕上锻炼。随着训练的进行，他们看起来越来越健康。第二组看着他们的虚拟形象无所事事地闲逛。在实验结束后的 24 小时内，第一组人比第二组人更活跃，他们散步的时间更长，在健身房锻炼的时间更长。虽然目前还不清楚这种影响会持续多久，但毫无疑问，我们确实与虚拟自我有强烈的联系。

虽然研究表明，虚拟角色的使用对现实生活中的角色有益，但人们也认识到，虚拟角色也可以用来造福用户以外的人。这种操纵可能发生的一个明显例子是在广告期间。通过使用代表广告所针对人群的演员，广告公司可以让观众想象自己在使用特定的产品，从而增加销售额。研究还发现，演员越像消费者，观众对产品的感觉就越紧密。这一发现表明，广告公司甚至可能利用社交网站让消费者与广告建立更私人的联系。通过这种方式，一个人对产品的看法会受到很大影响，消费模式也会改变或修改。

56. It's an animation that represents a person in a virtual environment.

【解析】题目问文章中提到的化身是什么。根据题目定位至文章第一段，第一段倒数第三句提到，你通过虚拟环境中代表你的动画化身，经历了整个体验。avatar 后的 animation 是其同位语，在 animation 后接了一个定语从句，进一步解释了化身的意思。

57. Just three minutes.

【解析】题目问人们需要观察自己的替身多长时间才能影响他们的学习能力。根据题目定位至文章第二段，第二段倒数第二句提到，据说只要花三分钟看自己的替身，就能影响我们的学习能力、行为甚至观点。

58. Since we tend to remember personal information more effectively than other kinds.

【解析】题目问为什么替身可以作为一种有效的学习工具。根据题目定位至文章第三段，第三段最后一句提到，而且，与其他类型的信息相比，我们往往更能有效地记住个人信息，所以使用虚拟角色，尤其是替身，可以成为一种有效的学习工具。该句中的 the use of avatars, especially doppelgängers avatars 对应题干中的 doppelgängers (can) be used.

59. Our virtual selves.

【解析】题目问通过使用我们自己的数字图像，我们倾向于与谁产生强烈的联系。根据题目定位至文章倒数第二段，倒数第二段第二句和最后一句提到，研究表明，我们的行为可以通过使用自己的数字图像来改变。虽然目前还不清楚这种影响会持续多久，但毫无疑问，我们确实与虚拟自我有强烈的联系。由此可知本题答案。

60. By using actors that represent the section of the population the advertisement is aimed at.

【解析】题目问根据最后一段，公司如何增加销售额。根据题目定位至文章最后一段，最后一段第三句提到，通过使用代表广告所针对人群的演员，广告公司可以让观众想象自己在使用特定的产品，从而增加销售额。

Section C

【原文翻译】

直到最近几十年，双语都是非常不受欢迎的，人们认为其对语言发展有害。正如 1926 年的一项期刊研究所指出的那样：“从智力测试的结果来看，在家使用外语是导致智力迟钝的主要因素之一。”

选择不使用母语不仅仅是出于教育上的考虑，也是出于社会上的考虑——母语总是被认为是耻辱的来源，是贫穷或与与众不同的标志，几乎肯定会导致被排斥和欺负。

当一项针对蒙特利尔的法语单语使用者和英法双语者的学术研究开展后，舆论的方向开始出现逆转。该研究的作者伊丽莎白·皮尔和华莱士·E·兰伯特曾期望通过各种测试来证明单语者比双语者更有能力，但事实恰恰相反。他们说：“在智力上，双语儿童对两种语言系统的体验似乎使他/她拥有更多样化的心理能力。”学者们首次提出，接触多种语言非但不会成为障碍，反而会带来明显的优势。

在接下来的20年里，各种各样的学者不断推动这一结果，设计出能力倾向测试，显示双语者在解决问题、语言意识和符号操作方面略微更有能力。测试做得越多，神经学家和认知科学家就越关注“执行控制”，即大脑额叶中的认知技能，它支持高层次的思维、记忆、注意力和多任务处理。

双语对神经可塑性的影响似乎很明显，因此研究人员需要了解大脑是如何使用两种或两种以上的语言的。经过数百次实验，得出的结论是，双语者的大脑不是有两个不同的“口袋”存放两种语言，而是有一个巨大的口袋存放两种语言。在任何语言环境下，双语者的大脑都会开始“联合激活”，在适当的语言中寻找正确的单词。当然，这需要立即抑制和激活，停止错误的语言，授权正确的语言。结果就是所谓的“增强的注意力控制”，对注意力、记忆力等方面都有明显的影响。

在生活方面，双语似乎有积极的影响。加拿大心理学家艾伦·比亚韦斯托克是这一领域的主要研究人员之一，她分析了被诊断为痴呆症的患者们的医疗记录，发现双语者在三到四年后才诊断出症状（平均年龄为78.6岁，而单语者为75.4岁）。

这项研究确实表明，双语就像弹钢琴或下棋等其他具有智力挑战的活动一样，可以减缓与年龄相关的衰退。然而，有明显的缺点和优点。双语者在每一种语言中的语言能力一般都低于单语者；词汇量更小；而且，双语者在理解和产生单词方面的反应时间较慢。这就好像一些双语者可以说两种语言的95%，而不是100%。对于那些希望自己的孩子成为口齿伶俐、精通语言的人来说，这缺失的5%是一个大漏洞，尤其是如果你想让他们完全欣赏但丁或莎士比亚的作品的话。但正如法国心理语言学家弗朗索瓦·格罗斯让所说，双语者并不是“两个单语者合二为一”，也不应该根据单语参数来判断。

去年11月，伦敦东汉姆区的圣斯蒂芬斯成为第一所登上《星期日泰晤士报》学校排行榜榜首的非私立学校。值得注意的是，96%的学生将英语作为一门额外的语言。这似乎证明了学术研究多年来一直在说的话：保持“母语”可能有利于学习“社区语言”，熟练掌握第一种语言就能熟练掌握第二种语言。安东内拉索瑞斯是爱丁堡大学双语问题研究和信息中心的主任，该中心致力于在苏格兰和全球推广多语言。她说：“几十年来，有一种观点认为，同时学习两种语言，或者太快学习两种语言，会影响孩子。这会在学校造成问题。这一直是家长们得到的信息，但绝对没有证据证明；事实上，恰恰相反。”

多伦多大学的吉姆·康明斯和弗吉尼亚·科利尔进行的研究最终消除了这种偏见。他们发现，母语能力强的学生在第二语言中表现出“认知学术语言能力”的时间要比母语不强的学生快得多。这意味着，对于移民儿童来说，在家里听到一种语法正确、表达丰富的流利语言比接触低水平的洋泾浜英语要有利得多。然后，他们可以将这些语言技能——概念、措辞和复杂的结构——转移到他们的新语言中。

从康明斯和科利尔到比亚韦斯托克，有这么多关于双语的前沿研究来自多伦多，这并不奇怪。据估计，多伦多有一半的居民会说两种语言。但这些数字现在已成为常态：56%的欧洲公民和60%的洛杉矶居民都能熟练使用两种语言。在全球范围内，通晓两种语言和多种语言的人数被认为超过了50%，而且还在上升，这意味着只会一种语言不再是默认的，而通晓多种语言只是一个奇怪的例外。

61. a distinct advantage 【解析】根据题目定位至文章第二段最后一句“*For the first time, academics were suggesting that, far from being an obstacle, exposure to more than one language could offer a distinct advantage.*”即学者们首次提出，接触多种语言非但不会成为障碍，反而会带来明显的优势。因此本空填 a distinct advantage。

62. enhanced attentional control 【解析】根据题目定位至文章第四段，提到经过数百次实验，得出的结论是，双语者的大脑不是有两个不同的“口袋”存放两种语言，而是有一个巨大的口袋存放两种语言。在任何语言环境下，双语者的大脑都会开始“联合激活”，在适当的语言中寻找正确的单词。结果就是所谓的“增强的注意力控制”，对注意力、记忆力等方面都有明显的影响。因此本空填 enhanced attentional control。

63. age-related 【解析】根据题目定位至文章倒数第四段第一句“*The research does suggest that bilingualism, like other mentally challenging activities such as playing the piano or chess, can slow down age-related decline.*”，即这项研究确实表明，双语就像弹钢琴或下棋等其他具有智力挑战的活动一样，

可以减缓与年龄相关的衰退。空格所在句中从句为 Although 引导的让步状语从句，内容是关于双语者的缺点，主句中有 when 引导的时间状语从句，内容是关于双语者的优点，即双语者的优点是减缓与年龄相关的衰退。因此本空填 age-related。

64.proficiency 【解析】根据题目定位至文章倒数第三段第三句“This seemed proof of what academic research had been saying for years: that the maintenance of a ‘home language’ may be beneficial for learning ‘the community language’, that proficiency in that first tongue enables proficiency in the next.”即这似乎证明了学术研究多年来一直在说的话：保持“母语”可能有利于学习“社区语言”，熟练掌握第一种语言就能熟练掌握第二种语言。因此本空填 proficiency。

65.cognitive academic language proficiency 【解析】根据题目定位至文章倒数第二段前两句“The research that finally put that prejudice to bed was conducted by Jim Cummins and Virginia Collier at the University of Toronto. They discovered that students who were competent in their first language would display ‘cognitive academic language proficiency’ (CALP) in a secondary language far sooner than those who didn’t have a strong native language.”即多伦多大学的吉姆·康明斯和弗吉尼亚·科利尔进行的研究最终消除了这种偏见。他们发现，母语能力强的学生在第二语言中表现出“认知学术语言能力”的时间要比母语不强的学生快得多。题目中的 demonstrate 对应第二句中的 display。因此本空填 cognitive academic language proficiency。

Part V Translation

Section A

66. 冰山形成时，发出雷鸣般的巨响，空中激起数百英尺高的水柱，海浪轻轻地拍打着你的船。你享受着每一刻，冰川的裂冰景象和声音一次又一次让你激动。这就是迷人的冰州湾的魅力所在，在这里最令大震撼的自然力量占据了中心舞台。

【解析】第一句为复合句，从句是由 when 引导的时间状语从句。从句谓语为 is born，意为“诞生；形成”，like 为介词，意为“像……一样”。第二句为由 and 连接的并列句，hundreds of feet 意为“数百英尺”。第三句为主谓宾结构，谓语动词是 relish，意为“享受”，every moment 作宾语，marveling as the sights and sounds of calving glaciers thrill you again and again 作状语，as 引导时间状语从句。最后一句是由 where 引导的非限制性定语从句，先行词是 Glacier Bay，enchanting 为前置修饰语，意为“迷人的”，定语从句中主语是 natural forces，the most astounding 意为“最令人震惊的；最令人震撼的”，谓语为 take centre stages，可译为“占据了中心舞台”。

Section B

67.The Twenty-four Solar Terms is a general name for a group of solar terms from the Beginning of Spring to Great Cold. It shows the relationship between universe, season, climate and agricultural production, which is a unique creation in Ancient China. The formation and development of The Twenty-four Solar Terms are closely related to China’s agricultural production. In the early stage of agricultural development, due to the needs of farming activities such as sowing and harvesting, people began to explore the pattern of seasonal changes in agricultural production. Gradually, there formed the concept of “Sow in Spring, Grow in Summer, Harvest in Autumn and Store in Winter”.

【解析】第二句中“是中国古代……”，可以翻译成 which 引导的非限制性定语从句，用 which 指代前面整个句子，主干内容是“它表现了关系”。“独特的创造”可译为 unique creation。“在农业发展初期”为时间状语，“由于……的需要”为原因状语，时态用一般过去时。“春种、夏长、秋收、冬藏”可译为 Sow in Spring, Grow in Summer, Harvest in Autumn and Store in Winter。

Part VI IQ Test

68.frosty 【解析】题目要求的是：把混乱的大写字母重新排列成一个合适的单词。这个答案将使这个句子更加完整。例句意为“_____是有条纹的动物”，打乱的字母组合是 BEZAR，例句说的是动物，则 ZEBRA 意为“斑马”，符合。综上，空格处打乱的字母组合是 SFRYOT，空格处所在句意为“今天早晨天气晴朗和_____”，那么字母组合应是表示早晨天气状况的词，FROSTY 意为“霜冻的；结霜的”，符合，故答案是 FROSTY。

69.Rhombus 【解析】题目要求：有两个蓝色的形状，一个绿色的形状和一个黄色的形状。椭圆形不是绿色的。下面的配对由不同颜色的形状组成：椭圆形和三角形，菱形和椭圆形，菱形和正方形，正方形和椭圆形，三角形和菱形。哪个形状是绿色的？根据题意可知，一共有四种形状分别是：椭圆形、三角形、菱形和正方形。椭圆形和菱形都和除自己外的另外三种图形配对，而且颜色都不同，推测椭圆形和菱形肯定不是蓝色，因为蓝色形状有两个，那么椭圆形和菱形中必定有一个是绿色一个是黄色，根据题干可知，椭圆形不是绿色的，所以绿色的形状一定是菱形，故答案为 Rhombus。

70.wire; mare 【解析】题目要求的是：填入一个与大写字母单词意思相似且与第二个单词押韵的单词。CABLE 意为“电缆”，tyre 后半部分音标是 /aɪə/；HORSE 意为“马”，hair 后半部分音标是 /eə(r)/。因此本题答案分别是 wire 和 mare。

71.A. 【解析】题目问哪个是缺失的部分。观察图形可以发现：每行每列的三角形中的图形都仅出现一次；每行每列中的三角形的顶角都是有一个与其他不同；三角形中左边的底角都是点状，每行每列三角形右边底角都是两个灰色一个空白。综上，故选 A。

72.55km/h. 【解析】题目要求的是：一位教授以固定的速度（不超过 90 公里/小时）开车去他城外的实验室。仪表上一度显示有 16961 公里的里程。两小时后，计价器上的数字再次显示出两个方向上的读数相同。问教授开车的速度是多少 (km/h)。根据题意，在 2 小时后，表盘数字以中间数字为对称轴，两边数字对称，且时速不超 90 千米，由此可推断，表盘数字在 16961+180 之间，且要满足对称条件，推断此时表盘数字应为 17071，那么教授当时的时速为 $(17071 - 16961) \div 2 = 55$ 。因此答案为 55km/h。

Part VI Error Correction

73.can ∧ attributed → be 【解析】can 是情态动词，后接动词原形，固定短语 attribute...to... 意为“将……归因于……”，该句中使用的是其被动语态。故在 attributed 前添加 be。

74.Countlessly → Countless 【解析】Countlessly 为副词，意为“无数地，不计其数地”，此处需用形容词修饰名词 studies，故将 Countlessly 改为 Countless。

75.where → which/that 【解析】分析句子结构可知，该句中 where 后是一个定语从句，引导词在定语从句中作主语，先行词是 painkiller 指物，但 where 在定语从句中充当地点状语，故将 where 改为 which 或 that。

76.in 【解析】assemble 作及物动词时，意为“召集；装配”，作不及物动词时，意为“聚集；集合”。此处是指“召集”学生，宾语是“一群学生”。因此删除 in。

77.another → other 【解析】one...the other 意为“一（人或物）……另一……”，用来表示两者中的一个和另一个，此处想要表达两个食指的状况。因此将 another 改为 other。

78.little → less 【解析】此处是指将涂了假止痛药的手指与没涂的手指进行比较。much 修饰比较级，表示“……得多”，而 little 为原级。因此将 little 改为 less。

79.except → exception 【解析】该句中 without 为介词，后面接名词或者动名词形式，except 是动词，其名词形式为 exception，且固定短语 without exception，意为“毫无例外”。因此将 except 改为 exception。

80.conventional → unconventional 【解析】结合句意可知，该句中人们提出质疑的是“非常规药物”。因此需将 conventional 改为 unconventional。

81.attribute → attributes 【解析】该句中的 attribute 位于形容词 medical 和介词 of 之间，所以此处的 attribute 为名词，作名词意为“属性”，需要使用复数形式。因此需将 attribute 改为 attributes。

82.oneself → itself 【解析】反身代词 oneself 用来指人，而原句中指的是物 drug，因此需将 oneself 改为 itself。

Part VIII Writing

Section A

83.【参考范文】

What is the most important thing in life?

From the observed data, it is clear that different age groups place different priorities on life, focusing on areas such as money, relationships and health.

For persons under 25 years of age, more than a quarter (26%) cite relationships or money as the most important aspect of their lives. In addition, one in 10 people value job satisfaction or music the most, followed by fashion at 8 percent, which is not found among those aged 55 and over. A smaller fraction (6%) prioritizes health. In contrast, nearly a third of people aged 55 and older put their health first. In this older age group, the importance placed on money and relationships dropped significantly from 26% to 15% and 10%, respectively. In addition, 8% of people in this age group consider family an important aspect.

In conclusion, it is clear that people's values and priorities change as they age.

【解析】题目要求通过选择和报告图表中主要特征来总结信息，并在必要时进行比较。两张图分别展示了 25 岁以下人群和 55 岁以上人群认为他们生命中最重要的东西的调查结果。写作时先概述图表反映的信息，即对于不同年龄层的人，生活中最重要的东西是有差异的；其次描述对于不同年龄层的人所认为的生活中最重要的东西进行比较，最后进行总结。

Section B

84.【参考范文】

How can local governments promote tourism?

Local authorities can promote tourism by improving facilities or sponsoring cultural events. It has gained a positive reputation by increasing the accessibility of an area through improved transport infrastructure. Therefore, local authorities should focus on improving transport options in their region, not only to provide comfortable accommodation for tourists, but also to improve the quality of life for residents. In addition, organizing festivals, cultural celebrations or local events is another effective strategy to promote tourism. These activities provide an additional incentive for visitors to visit.

In my opinion, the latter approach is more influential. Festivals are crucial in creating a vibrant and joyous environment, which in turn increases the attractiveness of the destination and attracts more visitors. In addition, festivals can serve as a key tool for tourism management, especially in encouraging off-season travel. Events held during the off-season offer a unique reason to visit, as hotel occupancy rates are typically lower, which can extend the entire tourist season.

In conclusion, local authorities must give priority to cultural celebrations as a means to unite people and attract tourists.

【解析】题目要求讨论观点并给出自己的观点，在你的笔记中讨论地方当局可以增加旅游业的两种方式，并解释你认为哪种方式更有效。写作时首先可以选择两种方式，并阐述不同的观点；其次表达自己的观点并分析原因，最后总结全文。

听力原文

Part I Listening Comprehension

Section A

*In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you have **fifteen seconds** to read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

1.W: Steve, I'm going to watch the race on Saturday, but I don't know where it ends and when it begins.

M: This year's motorcycle race will finish in the city center. Hundreds of people are expected to be on the square in front of the town hall to watch the finish of the race on Saturday afternoon. For those who'd like to see the bikes in action, seating will be provided on the square outside the stadium. Race organizers recommend that from Caste Square, with its position on top of the hill, there'll be a good view of the bikes making their way through the city.

Question: Where is the motorcycle race going to finish?

2.W: Hi, John. Can you talk about the travel programmes you've made?

M: People always ask me why I only travel the hard way! A lot of travel programmes are about relaxing holidays on the beach, but I've only ever made documentaries about really long trips. The last trip I did was a 50,000-mile journey around the Pacific Ocean, and it took 12 months. But then my very first trip was 'around the world' journey, and the most difficult one was probably a car journey from the North Pole to the South Pole.

Question: What have made John's travel programmes special?

3.W: Have you seen the draw for the tournament?

M: Yes, and it seems as if some players have got lucky.

W: Especially Martin and John. They'll probably never get a better chance of winning it.

M: I agree, but when they play in tournaments, they seem to be affected by pressure and get nervous. And when John gets nervous, he loses concentration even though he's one of the most talented players we have.

W: That's what happened last year, isn't it?

M: Exactly. In my opinion, this year's final would be between Andy and Tim, but they're due to meet in the semifinals. I think the result of that match will be decided by the fact that Tim hasn't fully recovered from his injury.

Question: Who does the man think will win?

4.M: So, how do you think you got on?

W: Not that well, I'm afraid.

M: Why? You usually do really well in organic chemistry.

W: I know, but because this was the last exam, I left my revision till the last moment and couldn't revise everything I needed to. So, I decided to revise some parts thoroughly and just hope they'd all come up. Unfortunately, when I read the questions, I realized I couldn't answer all of them as well as I'd have liked. Oh, I got through it all in time, but I won't get a very high mark.

Question: Why didn't the woman do well in the exam?

5.W: Never before have I been so insulted. I'm not going to buy any car from their store.

M: What happened? I thought he explained things okay.

W: He paid no attention to me and only looked at you. He thought I couldn't afford it.

Question: What does the woman mean?

Section B

*In this section, you will hear **two** long conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause. During the pause, read the questions and make your answers on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

Conversation One

*Listen to the conversation. Then read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

W: In the studio today we have Michael Blaine, one of Britain's most experienced actors with over four decades of screen success. Welcome, Michael.

M: Thank you.

W: Now, why haven't we seen much of you on screen recently?

M: That's out of choice. You see, I'm now in a position to pick and choose the roles I accept and if the right ones don't come along, I prefer not to take them on at all.

W: What makes a role right for you?

M: It's not the money any longer, thank goodness. It's more to do with the freshness of the role. I mean if I consider the role to be stale—the type that we've seen on screen over and over again, I'll reject it. If, on the other hand, it's fresh and challenging, I think it over seriously.

W: Do you want to know who is going to be in the film before you make your decision?

M: That's obviously important, but my decision is mainly based on the role itself.

W: What about playing alongside younger, more inexperienced actors? Do you tend to get angry if they don't get it right quickly?

M: There are some older actors who do tend to lose their temper, but what you must remember is that the success of a film is based on cooperation. So, I'd rather give a younger actor guidance than criticism. It's far better to feel tired after a day's filming because you've been helping someone than it is to feel exhausted because you've become frustrated.

W: Obviously, you haven't always been able to pick and choose your roles. How difficult was it for you when you were starting your career?

M: It might sound strange but being English and male didn't help. Just like today, Hollywood set the standard and male actors from England were mainly considered for more sensitive roles, not the all-action ones that have made male American actors famous.

W: But in some of your early films you played characters who spread fear, didn't you?

M: I was one of the first—an exception to the rule if you like. Luckily, I was pretty successful.

W: Talking about success, what do you think makes a film successful?

M: It's always great to be acknowledged by your fellow actors, get awards and see the film attracting huge audiences, but that's not everything. I think that if you can honestly say the whole cast and director worked together to produce something special, something out of the ordinary, then box office success becomes secondary.

W: And, of course, expressing emotion effectively helps make a film special. Has this become easier as you've got older?

M: Not really. I mean when I've got to feel sad, or cry in a film, all I have to do is recall a memory. It's

the same one I've used for years. I can't tell you about it because it would stop me using it again.

W: We've had some emails requesting me to ask you about your favourite role. Can you tell us?

M: I'm not sure I can answer that specific question. There have been scenes I have particularly enjoyed. Actually, I've thought about this several times and I've reached the conclusion that my best acting moments have come when I've been playing opposite an actor I have had a chemistry with. You know, someone who inspires you and whom you inspire. In those cases, everything comes naturally. Unfortunately, they're rare but when they happen, they're tremendously rewarding.

W: Would you say you've accomplished all your goals in acting?

W: I don't think I began my acting career with any specific goals and I still don't have any. The excitement of becoming an actor, getting roles I wanted and having the critics be kind to me on most occasions have been enough to satisfy me. I suppose I've approached acting with a one-step-at-a-time strategy, which, for me, has turned out to be the right one.

W: What about directing?

M: I've thought about it, but I've always felt that my place is in front of the camera and that's the way it'll stay until I can't do it any longer.

W: Thank you very much for your time.

Conversation Two

*Listen to the conversation, and complete the following sentences according to what you hear with **one word** for each blank. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

W: Hi, James, come in and have a seat. How's it going?

M: Well, I'm having a bit of trouble with my essay on the social and environmental history of Glasgow. I've written a complete draft of the essay, but I'm not happy with it. I don't think it's very good, and I want to get some advice about it. What do you think about it?

W: OK, well, I've read it a couple of times, and while I think you have some really original ideas, the structure I find a bit confusing. I can't really follow the flow of the essay, and your conclusion is a bit unclear.

M: Yes, I know what you mean. What do you think I could do about it?

W: Did you make a detailed plan of the essay before you started?

M: To be honest, I was going to make a plan, and I normally plan in a lot of detail, but I was a bit short of time, so this time I just wrote it. I guess that explains why it wasn't very clear to read.

W: Yes, I'm sure that's the case. I'd advise you to start again with a detailed plan, and then rewrite it. Keep the ideas, but see if you can organise and write it in a way that makes it easier to read.

M: OK, I'll do that. When do you want me to hand it in?

W: Well, as you know, the last day you can submit the essay is next Friday, so if you could get me a draft by Monday, I'll have time to give you feedback before the deadline. Is that manageable for you?

M: It will mean a busy weekend, but yes, that's fine. Shall I email it to you, or would you rather have a hard copy?

W: It would be a lot easier for me if you could email me an electronic copy, so that I can write some comments on it and send it back to you by the end of the day. That way you'll have time to take on board any feedback or comments before Friday.

M: OK, great, that's really helpful, thank you.

W: Now, we've talked about the organization, so let's discuss the content. As I said, there are some really good ideas here, but I want to talk through some of your points and see if we can improve them.

M: OK.

W: Firstly, you wrote about the development of Glasgow in the 19th century, from a small town to a major trade centre in Europe. I like what you wrote, but I think you should write more about how that process came about. I mean, the main reason seems to be the fact that shipbuilding techniques improved dramatically, but you haven't really mentioned this, so I think you should expand on that a bit more, what do you think?

M: Yes, that's a fair point, I'll do that. What else would you change?

W: Well, again, I thought your insights into 19th-century poverty in the East End of Glasgow were

very interesting, but I would look more into the issue of poor housing, because I think that was the biggest cause of ill health at the time.

M: OK, that's fair enough, I'll do that, too. Is there anything you think I should read to find out more about it?

W: Yes, there's a great book called *The Working Poor*, which has a lot of excellent research into working-class housing in Glasgow at the time. I'd recommend Chapters 2 and 3 in particular. You can find it in the library.

M: That's great, thank you. I'll look at that.

W: Finally, no essay on the social history of Glasgow would be complete without a section on air pollution. You'll have seen the old films where the air was full of smog, and this was the result of factory pollution. It wasn't until the Clear Air Act was introduced in 1956 that Glasgow's air became cleaner, along with the rest of the country. I'd definitely look at that. There's a chapter on it in the same book.

M: Brilliant. That's absolutely great. Many thanks for your help.

W: Good luck with it, and I look forward to reading your next draft.

Section C

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the four choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

16. Everyone knows that light attracts insects. In prehistoric times, our ancestors questioned why winged insects buzzed around fire. An old saying describes this attraction as being, "like a moth to a flame". However, a recent study dispels the long-believed notion that insects head towards light because they like it. Biologists at Imperial College London have reported that insects are drawn to light because it helps with their orientation when in flight. The scientists said artificial light actually disorients nocturnal bugs like moths and mosquitos, often to fatal ends. Jamie Theobald, co-author of the study, said all our speculations about why insects fly toward light "might have been wrong".
17. Many people believe that putting the toilet-seat lid down helps to prevent the spread of dangerous germs and viruses. A recent study pretty much dispels this supposition. A team of microbiologists from the University of Arizona conducted research on the aerial activity of viral particles after a toilet is flushed. The scientists determined that there is little difference in the spread of germs, regardless of whether the lid is up or down. Microbiologist Dr Charles Gerba has been studying lavatory pathogens for nearly five decades. He said, "All that air when you flush goes somewhere, and it carries the viruses that are in the toilet bowl out of it." He said a flush forces bacteria out from under the lid and contaminates nearby areas.
18. Australia's unique ecosystems are under threat from an invasive and deadly species—the red fire ant. The tiny ant is native to South America, but has spread across the globe over the past century. It is one of the world's most invasive creatures. It causes extensive damage to crops and agricultural land. It also kills large numbers of indigenous insects and other animals, including livestock. The ant's painful and venomous sting can cause severe allergic reactions in humans. It can also cause fatal anaphylactic shock. A spokeswoman for the Minister of Agriculture called the fire ants "a terrible invasive super-pest, which cause serious social, economic and environmental harm".
19. An uplifting story has popped up in our news feeds. Four children who were missing and feared dead after a plane crash a month ago have been found alive and well. The siblings, aged thirteen, nine, four and a one-year-old baby, were on a plane that crashed in the Amazon jungle in Colombia on May the first. The children's mother, the pilot and co-pilot perished in the crash. Before the plane disappeared, the pilot issued an SOS, citing engine failure. Moments later, it disappeared from radar screens. The children had been missing for 40 days when members of Colombia's military found them. A news agency said people from the Huitoto indigenous group in the jungle aided the soldiers' search. It believes the siblings escaped the wreckage and trudged through the jungle in search of help. The children belong to the Huitoto group. Their knowledge of what is edible in the jungle and their experience of the terrain probably gave them a better chance of survival.
20. Finland's national carrier Finnair has started weighing passengers on its flights from the capital city

of Helsinki. The weigh-ins are being done on a voluntary basis and are completely anonymous. A company spokesperson said the new initiative is to ensure safety standards on flights are adhered to. He said any airplane should not exceed the prescribed maximum weight for safe take-offs and landings. This weight is made up of the aircraft itself, the fuel, checked baggage and cargo, onboard catering, water tanks, and passengers. Finnair officials were initially concerned about a customer backlash because weight is such a personal issue. However, in the first week of the tests, over 1,000 passengers had agreed to be weighed.

Section D (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **one** monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **not more than five words**. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

The Notting Hill Carnival is the largest of its kind in Europe—a huge street festival that celebrates the culture and traditions of Afro-Caribbean communities. It is a yearly event that takes place on August Bank Holiday weekend and floods the streets of West London with a sea of colourful floats, thousands of dancers in flowery costumes, music and the inviting smells of traditional Caribbean cooking.

Its origins go as far back as the Caribbean carnivals of the early 19th century which celebrated the abolition of slavery and the end of the slave trade. Having been forbidden from holding any festival of their own before, the people of Trinidad rebelled by dressing up in European style costumes and whitening their faces with flour or wearing white masks to imitate the style of their former masters, a tradition which is reflected in the costumes of today.

Elements of those early carnivals were first showcased in London in St Pancras Town Hall in 1959. Several indoor events were held by the Caribbean community, but the origin of the present festival was a happening which took place in 1966. A street party organized for neighbourhood children turned into a carnival procession when the steel band decided to take a walk while playing their music and were joined by an enthusiastic crowd. Almost fifty carnivals later, the few hundreds of locals have turned into hundreds of thousands of visitors flocking in from all over London, the UK, as well as from around the world.

After a whole year of preparation, the carnival bands take to the streets on Sunday and Bank Holiday Monday from 9 a. m. to 7 p. m. Sunday is traditionally dedicated to children with smaller crowds, more child-friendly floats and the annual costume awards. Monday is adults' day and it's reserved for serious partying to the hypnotic rhythms of the steel bands and mobile sound systems.

If you are planning a visit this year, it might pay to follow some simple advice to make your experience as comfortable as possible, so here goes:

Don't even think of taking a car as most of the local roads will be for pedestrians only and there will also be a lot of parking restrictions. Public transport is your best option, although do bear in mind that underground stations might close temporarily for reasons of safety if they become overcrowded. When in the crowd, remember it might be dangerous to move against the flow. Move with it and slightly sideways until you find a safe exit.

Whether you aim to join in the fun or simply watch the crowds go by, make sure you wear comfortable clothes and shoes. The latter is particularly important, as the cleaning services don't get a chance to move in and clear litter until after Monday evening. If you are meeting friends, do arrange a meeting point beforehand. It's very easy to get lost in a crowd and you might have a hard time finding a signal so you can call them.